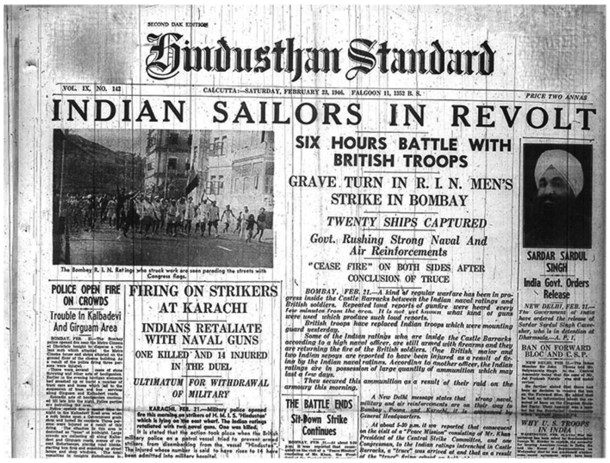
to other stations involving more than 20,000 ratings. Similar strikes occurred in the Indian Air Force and the Indian Signal Corps at Jabalpur. Thus the British hegemonic control ceased even in the armed forces.



SECOND DAK EDITION

Hindusthan Standard

VOL. IX, NO. 142 CALCUTTA:—SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 23, 1946. FALGOON 11, 1352 B. S. PRICE TWO ANNAS

INDIAN SAILORS IN REVOLT

The Bombay R. I. N. Ratings who struck work are seen parading the streets with Congress flags.

SIX HOURS BATTLE WITH BRITISH TROOPS

GRAVE TURN IN R. I. N. MEN'S STRIKE IN BOMBAY

TWENTY SHIPS CAPTURED

Govt. Rushing Strong Naval And Air Reinforcements

"CEASE FIRE" ON BOTH SIDES AFTER CONCLUSION OF TRUCE

BOMBAY, FEB. 21.—A kind of regular warfare has been in progress inside the Castle Barracks between the Indian naval ratings and British soldiers. Repeated loud reports of gunfire were heard every few minutes from the area. It is not yet known what kind of guns were used which produce such loud reports.

British troops have replaced Indian troops which were mounting guard yesterday.

Some of the Indian ratings who are inside the Castle Barracks according to a high naval officer, are still armed with firearms and they are returning the fire of the British soldiers. One British major and two Indian sepoys are reported to have been injured as a result of firing by the Indian naval ratings. According to another officer, the Indian ratings are in possession of large quantity of ammunition which may last a few days.

They secured this ammunition as a result of their raid on the armoury this morning.

A New Delhi message states that strong naval, military and air reinforcements are on their way to Bombay, Poona and Karachi, it is announced by General Headquarters.

At about 5-30 p.m. it was reported that consequent on the visit of a "Peace Mission" consisting of Mr. Khan President of the Central Strike Committee, and one Congressman, to the Indian ratings intrenched in Castle Barracks, a "truce" was arrived at and that as a result

THE BATTLE ENDS

Sit-Down Strike Continues

POLICE OPEN FIRE ON CROWDS

Trouble In Kalbadevi And Girguam Area

FIRING ON STRIKERS AT KARACHI

INDIANS RETALIATE WITH NAVAL GUNS

ONE KILLED AND 14 INJURED IN THE DUEL

ULTIMATUM FOR WITHDRAWAL OF MILITARY

KARACHI, FEB. 21.—Military police opened fire this morning on strikers of H. M. I. S. 'Hindustan' which is lying on the east wharf. The Indian ratings retaliated with two naval guns. One was killed.

It is stated that the action took place when the British military police on a patrol vessel tried to prevent armed strikers from disembarking from the vessel "Hindustan". The injured whose number is said to have risen to 14 have been admitted into military hospital.

SARDAR SARDUL SINGH

India Govt. Orders Release

NEW DELHI, FEB. 21.—The Government of India have ordered the release of Sardar Sardul Singh Caveesher, who is in detention at Dharmsala.—A. P. I.

BAN ON FORWARD BLOC AND C.S.P.

WHY U. S. TROOPS IN INDIA

Royal Indian Navy Revolt

### (b) Negotiating Independence: Simla Conference

The Wavell Plan was announced on 14 June 1945. It provided for an interim government, with an equal number of Hindus and Muslims in the Viceroy's Executive Council. All portfolios, except war portfolio, was to be held by Indian ministers. However, in the Simla Conference, the Congress and the Muslim League could not come to an agreement. Jinnah demanded that all the Muslim members should be from the Muslim League and they should have a veto on all important matters. In the provincial elections held in early 1946 the Congress won most of the general seats and the Muslim League won most of the seats reserved for the Muslims thus bolstering its claim.

### (c) Cabinet Mission

In Britain, the Labour Party had won a landslide victory and Clement Atlee became the Prime Minister. He declared that he wanted to transfer power at the earliest. He sent a Cabinet Mission comprising Pethick Lawrence, Sir Strafford Cripps and A.V. Alexander. Rejecting the demand for Pakistan, it provided for a Federal government with control over defence, communications and foreign affairs. The provinces were divided into three groups viz. Non-Muslim Majority Provinces, Muslim Majority Provinces in the Northwest and the Muslim Majority Provinces in the Northeast. A Constituent Assembly was to be elected and an interim government set up with representation for all the communities. The Congress and the Muslim League accepted the plan. However, both interpreted it differently.

### (d) Direct Action Day Call by Muslim League

Difference arose between Congress and Muslim League when the former nominated a Muslim member. The League argued it was to be the sole representative of the Muslims and withdrew its approval. Jinnah declared 16 August 1946 as the 'Direct Action Day'. Hartals and demonstrations took place which soon turned into Hindu-Muslim conflict. It spread to other districts of Bengal. The district of Noakhali was the worst affected.

### (e) Mountbatten Plan

The interim government headed by Jawaharlal Nehru was formed in September 1946. After some hesitation the Muslim League joined it in October 1946. Its representative Liaqat Ali Khan was made the Finance Member. In February 1947, Clement Atlee declared that power would be transferred by June 1948. Lord Mountbatten was sent as Viceroy to India with the specific task of transfer of power. On 3 June 1947 the Mountbatten Plan was announced. It proposed:

- Power would be transferred on the basis of dominion status to India and Pakistan.
- Princely states would have to join either India or Pakistan.
- Boundary commission was to be set up under Radcliffe Brown and the award